

Location affects protection & the generation of REDD: Observable characteristics drive park impacts in Costa Rica

This content has been downloaded from IOPscience. Please scroll down to see the full text.

2009 IOP Conf. Ser.: Earth Environ. Sci. 6 252023

(<http://iopscience.iop.org/1755-1315/6/25/252023>)

View [the table of contents for this issue](#), or go to the [journal homepage](#) for more

Download details:

IP Address: 141.213.236.110

This content was downloaded on 02/01/2014 at 20:30

Please note that [terms and conditions apply](#).

P25.14

Location affects protection & the generation of REDD: observable characteristics drive park impacts in Costa Rica

Alexander Pfaff(1), J Robalino(2), A Sanchez(3), K Andam(4), P Ferraro(5)

(1) Duke University, Department of Public Policy, Economics, Environment, Durham, NC, USA

(2) CATIE, Costa Rica

(3) University of Alberta, Canada

(4) International Food Policy Research Institute - IFPRI, Washington, DC, USA

(5) Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA, USA

To support conservation planning, we ask whether a park's impact on deforestation varies with observable characteristics that planners could use to prioritize sites. Using matching methods to avoid common biases in impact estimation, we find that deforestation impact varies with site characteristics. Avoided deforestation is greater on parks located closer to the capital city, on land closer to a national road, and on flatter land. In allocating scarce conservation resources, policy makers have to consider many factors, such as ecosystem services provided by a site and the costs of acquiring a site. Holding such factors fixed, Pfaff et al. 2004 conjecture that impact can be raised by protecting first, in a sequencing of protection, the sites less likely to survive outside parks. We provide empirical support for this argument in the context of Costa Rica's renowned park system. This insight, combined with information on eco-services and land costs, should guide investments.